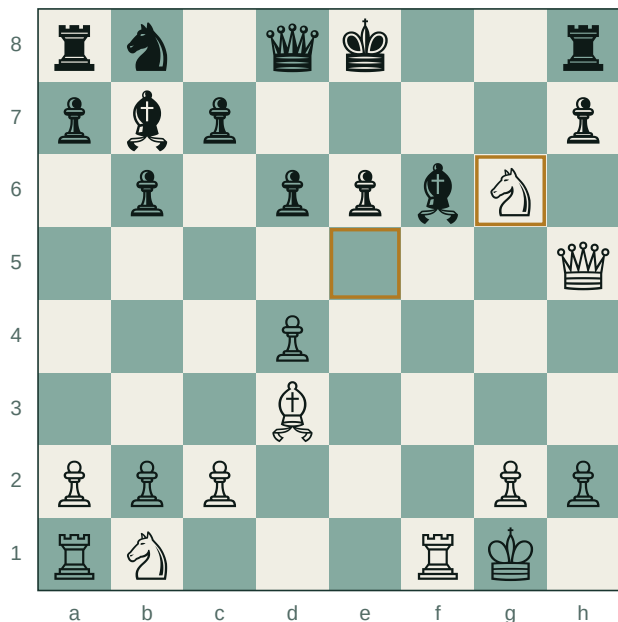


Intermediate moves: Black, move 13

Intermediate moves

Black to move



Previous move: 13.Nxg6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13...Bxd4+ 14. Kh1 hxg6 15. Qxg6+ Kd7 16. Rf7+ Kc8 17. Qxe6+ Nd7

13...Bxd4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on d4. Recorded reply: **14.Kh1**.

14...hxg6 The pawn captures the knight on g6. The changed line means the rook on h8 attacks the queen on h5. Recorded reply: **15.Qxg6+**.

15...Kd7 The king moves from e8 to d7. Recorded reply: **16.Rf7+**.

16...Kc8 The king moves from d7 to c8. Recorded reply: **17.Qxe6+**.

17...Nd7 The knight moves from b8 to d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 30 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The postponed recapture may disappear. The intermediate move must win enough or preserve the right to recover material.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An intermediate move interrupts an expected sequence with a stronger immediate threat. Instead of recapturing automatically, use a check or another forcing move to change the result.

HOW TO LOOK

Before every routine recapture, scan checks, queen attacks, and mating threats. Return to the original capture only if it still helps.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on h5 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.